Before Session 2: set up your computer

AI Agents for Descriptive Social-Science Research · Session 2: Thursday 12 November 2026, 15:30 EET

Complete these five steps in order and tick each one. Allow up to 90 minutes, and do not leave it to Thursday morning.

- **You need:** a computer on which you may install programs, internet, and a **personal** Google account (18 or older). You do not need Git, Node.js, Gemini CLI, or an API key, whatever the syllabus says.
- **Stay safe:** download only from the addresses below, and never enter payment details.
- **Security warning when opening a download?** Mac: right-click the app ➜ **Open** ➜ **Open**. Windows: **More info** ➜ **Run anyway**.
- **Stuck?** Email martin.alberdi@eui.eu the **step number** and a **screenshot** (no passwords visible) by **Wednesday 11 November, 18:00**. If it cannot be solved in time, you can work in a pair on Thursday.

☐ 1. Install VS Code (where you see your files)

1. Go to **code.visualstudio.com** and click **Download**.
2. **Mac:** drag **Visual Studio Code** from Downloads into **Applications** and open it. **Windows:** run the downloaded file and keep every default.
3. Skip any offer of an AI assistant or a sign-in.

✓ **You should see:** a **Welcome** tab and a bar of icons on the far left.

☐ 2. Install Python (runs the short scripts the agent will write)

1. Go to **python.org/downloads**.
2. **Mac:** click the yellow **Download Python 3.. . .** button and open the `.pkg` file. Click **Continue** until **Install**. In the folder that opens at the end, double-click **Install Certificates.command** and wait until it says it is complete.
3. **Windows:** do **not** use the yellow button. Click the link just below it, **"Or get the standalone installer for Python 3.. . ."**, and open the file. On the first screen, **tick "Add python.exe to PATH"**, then click **Install Now**.

✓ **You should see:** the installer says it finished. Do not install extra packages.

☐ 3. Add three extensions to VS Code (add-ons that give it new abilities)

In VS Code, click the **Extensions** icon (four small squares in the far-left bar). Search for each name, check the publisher, because imitations exist, and click **Install**.

Search for	Publisher	What it is
Google Antigravity	Google	The AI agent we use
Python	Microsoft	Lets VS Code work with Python
vscode-pdf	tomoki1207	Shows PDFs inside VS Code

Then click the new **Antigravity icon** in the far-left bar and sign in. Your browser opens: use your **personal** Google account, because university accounts may be blocked. If asked for a plan, choose the **free** one.

✓ **You should see:** a panel with a greeting and a chat box. The first start can take a minute or two. If it says your account or location is not eligible, stop and email me.

☐ 4. Download the course folder (the files we work on)

1. Go to **github.com/Martinalberdi/ai_agents_social_science** (no account needed). Click the green **Code** button ➜ **Download ZIP**.
2. Unzip it. **Mac:** double-click the file, unless your browser already did. **Windows:** right-click ➜ **Extract All**.
3. Move `ai_agents_social_science-main` into **Documents**. If it contains a folder with the same name, use the inner one.
4. In VS Code, choose **File** ➜ **Open Folder. . .** and open `youth_at_home_project` inside it. Click **Yes, I trust the authors**.

✓ **You should see:** `data`, `outputs`, `scripts`, and `GEMINI.md` in the list on the left.

☐ 5. Check that it works (by asking the agent)

With `youth_at_home_project` open, type these into the Antigravity chat box:

1. *What files are in this folder? Do not change anything.*
   ✓ It names `GEMINI.md`, `data`, `outputs`, and `scripts`.
2. *Which version of Python is installed on this computer? Only check; do not install anything.*
   It asks permission to run a command such as `python3 --version`. Read it, then allow it **this one time**, not "always".
   ✓ It reports a Python version beginning with 3.